



ACADEMIC INTEGRITY POLICY

Súkromné gymnázium Česká

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1. Introduction

1.1 What is Academic Integrity?

Academic integrity is a guiding principle in education and a choice to act in a responsible way whereby others can have trust in us as individuals. It is the foundation for ethical decision-making and behaviour in the production of legitimate, authentic and honest scholarly work.

According to the International Baccalaureate, academic integrity must be seen as a set of values and skills that promote personal integrity and good practice in teaching, learning and assessment. It is influenced by factors such as peer pressure, culture, parental expectations, role modelling and taught skills.

Academic integrity should form part of the ethical culture of the school community and be upheld by all members.

1.2 What is an Authentic Piece of Work?

Students are encouraged to embrace academic integrity by being original thinkers and producers of knowledge—to *be content creators, not content imitators*.

An authentic piece of work is based on a student's individual and original ideas, with the ideas and work of others fully acknowledged.

All assignments must use the student's own language, expression and ideas. Where sources are used, whether through quotation or paraphrasing, they must be clearly and appropriately acknowledged. This includes responses in examinations.

1.3 Rationale

SGČ (Súkromné gymnázium Česká) is committed to developing globally minded students who embody the IB Learner Profile and uphold strong ethical values. This Academic Integrity Policy provides a clear framework for maintaining high standards in teaching, learning, and assessment while ensuring fairness and equal opportunities for all students. It reflects the school's commitment to fostering an ethical culture in which all members of the community act responsibly and avoid academic misconduct.

The purpose of this policy is to:

- ensure fairness and equal opportunities
- promote ethical behaviour
- support students in producing authentic work
- maintain high standards in assessment practices



2. Roles and Responsibilities

2.1 DP Coordinator and Leadership Team

The DP Coordinator and leadership team are responsible for ensuring that academic integrity is upheld consistently across the school and in accordance with IB requirements.

- ensure the Academic Integrity Policy is applied fairly and consistently
- ensure that students, teachers, and parents understand and can access the policy
- report suspected cases of academic misconduct or maladministration to the IB
- oversee investigations in line with school and IB procedures
- ensure secure storage and handling of confidential IB materials and examinations
- communicate expectations, detection methods, and consequences clearly
- ensure consistency in referencing practices (e.g. Oxford referencing system) across subjects

2.2 Teachers

Teachers play an essential role in promoting academic integrity by designing authentic assessment tasks and clearly communicating expectations, including proper referencing. They monitor student progress through drafts, model honest academic behaviour, and apply consistent standards across all subjects.

Key responsibilities:

- Design authentic assessment tasks
- Provide clear guidance on referencing and expectations
- Monitor student progress through drafts
- Act as role models of academic integrity
- Apply consistent standards across subjects

2.3 Students' Rights and Responsibilities

Students are expected to act honestly and responsibly while being supported by clear guidance and fair procedures.

Students have the right to:



- be informed about academic integrity and its consequences
- provide an explanation if accused of misconduct

Students are responsible for:

- understanding different forms of academic misconduct
- submitting authentic work and not taking credit for others' work
- not sharing their work in ways that enable misconduct
- applying correct referencing and acknowledging all sources
- signing authenticity declarations for assessed work
- understanding the importance of intellectual property and ethical academic practice

2.4 Parents/Guardians

Parents play an important role in supporting academic integrity by understanding school and IB expectations and encouraging responsible student behaviour.

- familiarize themselves with the school's Academic Integrity Policy and relevant IB regulations
- understand what constitutes academic misconduct and its consequences
- support their children in managing their workload responsibly
- avoid providing or obtaining inappropriate assistance with assessed work
- communicate concerns or suspected cases of misconduct to the school when necessary

3. Promoting Academic Integrity

At our school, academic integrity is a fundamental principle that underpins all teaching and learning. In alignment with the expectations of the International Baccalaureate Diploma Programme, we are committed to fostering a culture of honesty, trust, fairness, respect, and responsibility.

Promoting academic integrity involves a proactive and educational approach. Students are explicitly taught the skills necessary to produce authentic work, including proper research methods, accurate referencing, and responsible use of information and communication technologies. The school provides guidance on ethical academic practices, including the appropriate use of digital tools and artificial intelligence, to ensure that all submitted work reflects the student's own understanding.

Teachers play a key role in modelling ethical behaviour, designing assessment tasks that encourage original thinking, and supporting students in developing the skills needed to avoid academic



misconduct. Students are expected to take responsibility for their work by acknowledging all sources and adhering to established academic conventions.

The school recognizes that developing academic integrity is an ongoing process. Therefore, we emphasize prevention, education, and reflection, ensuring that students understand both the value of integrity and the consequences of misconduct. Through consistent communication, clear expectations, and supportive guidance, we aim to empower students to act with integrity in all aspects of their academic work.

4. Academic Misconduct

4.1 Definition of Misconduct

Academic misconduct refers to any behaviour—intentional or unintentional—that results in, or has the potential to result in, an unfair advantage for a student or a disadvantage for others. It includes actions that compromise the integrity, authenticity, and fairness of academic work, such as plagiarism, collusion, cheating, or the misuse of information. Such behaviour undermines trust, violates established academic standards, and goes against the principles of honest and responsible learning.

4.2 Types of Misconduct

Type of Misconduct	Definition	Example
Plagiarism	Presenting another person's work or ideas as one's own without proper acknowledgment.	Copying text from a website without citation.
Collusion	Supporting academic misconduct by allowing one's work to be copied or shared inappropriately.	Sharing an assignment with a classmate.
Fabrication of Data	Creating, inventing, or altering data dishonestly.	Making up results for an experiment.
Duplication of Work	Submitting the same work for more than one assessment.	Using the same essay for two subjects.
Unauthorized Assistance	Receiving or giving inappropriate help.	Having another person complete an assignment.
Falsification of Records	Providing false information in documentation.	Falsifying CAS records.
Examination Misconduct	Violating exam rules.	Using unauthorized materials in exams.
Impersonation	Pretending to be another candidate.	Sitting an exam for someone else.



5. Procedures for Addressing Academic Misconduct

5.1 Detection of Dishonest Work

The school uses a combination of methods to identify possible cases of academic dishonesty and ensure fairness in assessment. Any suspected issues are carefully checked before conclusions are made, and evidence is considered from multiple sources.

- comparison of current work with students' previous submissions to identify inconsistencies in style or ability
- use of plagiarism detection tools to check originality and proper citation of sources
- teacher observation of student behaviour, progress during tasks, and writing process to detect irregularities

These approaches help maintain academic integrity and ensure that all work submitted is authentic and fairly produced.

The school uses plagiarism detection software on the assumption that it acts as a deterrent and decreases plagiarism cases.

However, these systems become redundant if the students truly understand what the purpose of their education is. Plagiarism detection software should not be a substitution for responsible and purposeful teaching.

5.2 Investigation Process

When academic misconduct is suspected, the school follows a fair and structured process to ensure that all cases are handled consistently and transparently. The aim is to understand the situation fully before any decision is made.

- meeting with the student to discuss the concern
- providing the student with an opportunity to explain their work
- collecting and documenting all relevant evidence
- involving the DP Coordinator in reviewing the case and supporting the process

This approach ensures fairness, accountability, and careful consideration of all information before a final decision is reached.



5.3 Documentation and Reporting

All cases of suspected academic misconduct are carefully documented and recorded to ensure transparency and consistency in the school's procedures. Proper reporting also helps maintain accountability at both school and IB level.

- written statements are collected from relevant parties
- cases are reported to the IB when required according to regulations
- all records are securely maintained by the school for future reference

6. Consequences and Sanctions

6.1 Internal School Consequences (School-managed)

When academic misconduct is confirmed, the school applies fair and consistent consequences that reflect the seriousness of the offence and aim to support student learning. Sanctions are designed not only to address misconduct but also to reinforce the importance of academic integrity and responsible behaviour.

- zero grade awarded for the affected work
- opportunity for re-submission where appropriate
- notification of parents or guardians
- placement on academic probation or further disciplinary action, depending on the severity and recurrence of the offence

These measures ensure accountability while also providing students with guidance to improve their academic practices.

6.2 External Consequences (IB-managed)

In cases where academic misconduct is confirmed in work submitted to the International Baccalaureate (IB), the matter is reported to the IB, and consequences are applied in accordance with IB regulations and procedures. These sanctions are determined by the IB and are intended to uphold the integrity and credibility of the Diploma Programme worldwide.

- no grade awarded for the subject, component, or entire session
- the IB Diploma may be withheld if requirements are not met
- disqualification from the current examination session or prohibition from registering for future sessions



All decisions made by the IB are final and are based on a thorough review of the evidence submitted by the school. These measures reflect the seriousness with which the IB treats academic misconduct and emphasize the importance of honesty and authenticity in all assessed work.

6.3 Appeals Process

Appeals may be submitted following IB procedures with valid evidence. These must be submitted within the deadlines and guidelines established by IB. All appeals are reviewed carefully, and outcomes are communicated through the school in accordance with IB policies.

7. Examination Conduct and Compliance

Students must always comply with all International Baccalaureate (IB) Diploma Programme examination regulations, ensuring that assessments are conducted fairly and under appropriate conditions. This includes adherence to the most recent *Diploma Programme Assessment Procedures* (current examination session), which outlines the official rules and expectations for candidates.

Students are expected to follow all IB regulations, use only authorized materials, and maintain appropriate conduct throughout the examination process. Failure to meet these expectations may result in serious consequences in accordance with IB policies.

7.1. Examination Misconduct

Academic misconduct includes any breach of the IB DP Examination Code of Conduct, such as:

- bringing unauthorized materials into the examination room (e.g., notes, mobile phones, unauthorized calculator software)
- engaging in disruptive behaviour during examinations
- sharing or receiving information about examination content within 24 hours after the examination
- communicating about examination content with individuals outside the school community within 24 hours before or after the examination

Students must always adhere to the IB Diploma Programme examination regulations, ensuring that all assessments are conducted fairly and under appropriate conditions. This includes compliance with the most recent IB publication, *Diploma Programme Assessment Procedures* (current examination session), which outlines the official rules and expectations for candidates.



- follow all IB regulations as outlined in the current *Diploma Programme Assessment Procedures* document
- avoid the use of unauthorized materials or assistance
- maintain proper conduct throughout the examination process

Failure to comply with these expectations may result in serious consequences in accordance with IB policies.

7.2 Two-Hour Supervision Rule

The two-hour supervision rule is an IB requirement designed to protect the integrity of examinations across different time zones. It ensures that no candidate gains an unfair advantage by accessing exam content before or after the official session.

The rule requires that students are kept under supervised conditions for a defined period before or after an examination, depending on the exam scheduling. It is implemented to:

- prevent time-zone cheating by restricting communication before and after exams
- ensure fairness for all candidates worldwide
- maintain the security and confidentiality of examination materials

During this supervision period, students must not have access to unauthorized materials, electronic devices, or any form of communication with others outside the examination setting. Failure to comply may be treated as a breach of IB examination regulations.

8. AI and Academic Integrity

The IB Academic Integrity policy includes an appendix titled “Guidance on the Use of Artificial Intelligence Tools,” which provides direction on the ethical use of such technologies in student work (International Baccalaureate Organization, 2019, 2023).

The International Baccalaureate Organization outlines four conditions under which teachers may confirm that a student’s work is authentic.

First, teachers must have observed the student developing the work overtime.

Second, the student must be able to explain their work and demonstrate understanding.



Third, the student must distinguish between their own ideas and those derived from other sources. **Finally**, the quality of the work must be consistent with the teacher's expectations of the student's ability (International Baccalaureate Organization, 2024).

Furthermore, the IB states that work produced, even partially, by artificial intelligence tools is not considered the student's own. Therefore, any AI-generated content must be clearly acknowledged in the body of the text and referenced in the bibliography. Failure to do so constitutes a form of academic misconduct (International Baccalaureate Organization, 2019, 2023).

AI tools may be used only when permitted by the teacher or by the requirements of the task. Any permitted use must be transparent and appropriately acknowledged and referenced. AI tools must not replace the student's own thinking, work or understanding.

Students must:

- acknowledge any use of AI tools in their work
- ensure that all submitted work reflects their own understanding
- verify the accuracy and reliability of AI-generated content

Failure to comply with these expectations constitutes academic misconduct and will be addressed in accordance with school and IB policies.

9. Implications of Academic Misconduct

Academic misconduct undermines learning, personal development, and trust within the school community. It contradicts the IB mission and prevents students from becoming independent, responsible learners.

Students who engage in academic misconduct may experience:

- lack of confidence in their abilities
- difficulty working independently
- limited understanding of the subject matter
- poor performance in exam conditions
- overreliance on others
- loss of trust from teachers and parents
- slower academic progress



9.1 Consequences of Academic Misconduct

Academic misconduct is treated seriously and addressed through a fair and structured process. If a teacher suspects intentional or significant misconduct, the DP Coordinator is involved, and an investigation is conducted. Parents are informed, and students may be required to provide a written statement. At SGC, any instance of academic dishonesty is to result in:

Offence / Misconduct	1st Offence	Repeated Offence
Lying to staff	Documented and investigated; conference with student and parents; counseling	Probation; counseling; possible expulsion if repeated
Cheating on tests/exams	Documentation collected; zero grade; no resubmission; parents notified	Probation; counseling; possible expulsion if repeated
Forging signatures	Documented and investigated; conference; counseling	Probation; counseling; possible expulsion
Plagiarism / Copying work	Documented; conference; counseling	Probation; counseling; possible expulsion
Submitting work not own	Documentation; zero grade; parents notified; counseling	Probation; counseling; possible expulsion
Stealing	Investigation; probation; restitution; parent conference; possible police involvement	Probation; counseling; possible expulsion

10. Investigation Procedure for External Assessment

If malpractice is detected in external assessment work, it will not be submitted, or if already submitted, the IB will be informed, and appropriate procedures will be followed in accordance with IB regulations on academic honesty.

If malpractice is suspected after submission, the IB Coordinator must inform the IB, and the school is required to investigate and provide statements and relevant evidence from all parties involved.

Cases of suspected malpractice are reviewed by the Final Award Committee, which determines, based on the evidence, whether to dismiss the allegation, proceed with further investigation, or apply appropriate action; if evidence is insufficient, the case is dismissed and a grade is awarded as normal.

Candidates suspected of malpractice will be invited by the Coordinator to provide a written explanation using IB templates, and, with their permission, a record of any interview may be documented.



10.1 External Consequences of Academic Misconduct

Offences and Penalties

- If academic misconduct is confirmed, no grade is awarded for the affected subject(s), and the IB Diploma is not granted. The student may still receive certificates for unaffected subjects and may register for future examination sessions.
- In serious or repeated cases, the student may be barred from future IB examinations.
- An IB qualification may be withdrawn at any time if academic misconduct is later discovered.
- Academic misconduct results in a recorded offence and a mark of zero for the affected work.
- Falsifying CAS records may delay the award of the diploma and requires proper completion of CAS requirements.
- If academic misconduct affects any part of an assessment component, no grade may be awarded for the entire subject.

10.2 External Appeals

An appeal may be made to the **Final Award Committee** within three months based on new evidence. Decisions may be appealed on valid grounds.

The IB Organization accepts appeals in five areas: results, academic misconduct (not penalties), special consideration, inclusive assessment arrangements, and other administrative decisions affecting results.

The *Diploma Programme: Assessment appeals procedure* outlines processes for each type. Appeals have two stages, each requiring a fee (refunded if upheld).

Stage 1 must be requested by the head of school or DP coordinator; Stage 2 may also be requested by the candidate or legal guardian(s). Requests require a form from IB via **IB Answers**. Contact: appeals@ibo.org.

Appeals are not allowed if school deadlines/procedures were not followed. They do not include re-marking or re-moderation and require new evidence of procedural error by the IB Organization. No legal representation is permitted.

Disputes are settled by arbitration by the Geneva Chamber of Commerce under the Swiss Chambers' Arbitration Institution Rules.



11. Citing and Referencing

Any written assignment in which the work of others is referenced, whether implicitly or explicitly, must include a Works Cited page that appropriately credits all sources consulted. The Works Cited page is required for all assignments, tasks, projects, and assessments. Whenever a source is used, it must be cited accurately and consistently.

At SGČ, the Oxford referencing style is used for all citations. Students are permitted to use citation generators to support correct formatting.

For more information, please refer to the SGČ Extended Essay guide.

Policy Review

This policy is reviewed annually and revised when required by changes in IB requirements, legislation or the school context. A comprehensive review is conducted as part of the five-year programme-evaluation cycle.

12. Policy Steering Committee (2026-2027)

Name of Policy	Academic Integrity Policy
Reviewed by	Svetlana Veselová, DP Coordinator Juraj Babic, Head of School/CAS Coordinator Simona Latková, EE Coordinator/English A, L&L Brooks Guetschow, IB Librarian
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13. References

International Baccalaureate Organization (IBO). *Academic Integrity*. Cardiff: IBO, 2019.

IBO. *Diploma Programme: Assessment Procedures*. Cardiff: IBO, 2024.

IBO. *Extended Essay Guide*. Cardiff: IBO, 2013.

IBO. *Programme Standards and Practices*. Cardiff: IBO, 2020.

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OpenAI. *ChatGPT (Version 2026)*. AI language model used for editing and refinement of policy text.